

DEBRE TSEHAY ABUNE AREGAWI TIGRAY ORTHODOX TEWAHEDO CHURCH

Church Services & Congregational Spiritual Life Assessment Survey

"In the name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit, One God. Amen."

Dear Beloved Faithful in Christ, Peace be unto you. To glorify Almighty God and nurture our sacred worship, sacramental life, spiritual education, youth programs, parish facilities, and community outreach, we prayerfully invite your thoughtful and anonymous feedback.

"Let all things be done decently and in order." — 1 Corinthians 14:40

Member Status:

☐ First-time / Guest

☐ New Member

☐ Existing Member

SURVEY INSTRUCTIONS

◆ **Marking Answers:** Mark the checkbox clearly next to your selection.

◆ **Multiple Choices:** Follow prompts for '(Select all that apply)' or '(Select one)'.

◆ **Applicability:** Skip any question that does not apply to you.

◆ **Confidentiality:** Anonymous & confidential. Do not write your name or phone.

SECTION 1: ABOUT YOU & YOUR SPIRITUAL JOURNEY

These questions help us understand and serve our diverse faithful across all generations.

1. What is your age group? (Select one)

☐ Under 18 years

☐ 18–28 years

☐ 29–38 years

☐ 39–48 years

☐ 49–60 years

☐ 61–75 years

☐ 76 years or older

2. What is your gender? (Select one)

☐ Male

☐ Female

3. How long have you been a member or visitor of this parish? (Select one)

☐ First-time / Guest

☐ Less than 6 months

☐ 6 months – 2 years

☐ 3–5 years

☐ More than 5 years

4. What primarily inspired or guided you to join our parish? (Select all that apply)

☐ Family or friend invitation

☐ Moved to the area

☐ Seeking spiritual guidance and peace in Christ

☐ Tigray Orthodox Tewahedo worship & community

☐ A holy day or special program

☐ Children or family ministry

☐ Other: _____

5. What is your primary motivation for attending church regularly? (Select all that apply)

☐ To grow closer to God

☐ To receive the Holy Mysteries / Sacraments

☐ Liturgy, prayer and chanting (Kidase / Zema)

☐ Sermon and spiritual teaching (Sibket)

☐ Fellowship and community

☐ Children and youth education

☐ Orthodox tradition and cultural connection

6. When you come to church, do you feel welcomed, respected, and included in the church family? (Select one)

☐ Always

☐ Often

☐ Sometimes

☐ Rarely

☐ Not yet

7. What would help visitors and members feel more welcomed and spiritually connected?

SECTION 2: DIVINE LITURGY, CHANTING (ZEMA) & SPIRITUAL SERVICES

Please reflect on Kidase, Kidan, Mahlet, Seatat, Zema/Mezmur, Sermon, Sunday School, Bible study, and other spiritual programs.

8. In which church services or programs do you participate most actively? (Select all that apply)

☐ Divine Liturgy (Kidase) & Holy Communion

☐ Sunday School & Youth Program

☐ Mahlet, Seatat, and Kidan (Night/Morning Prayers)

☐ Bible Study & Adult Spiritual Classes

☐ Sunday Sibket (Sermons & Spiritual Teachings)

☐ Virtual / Online Spiritual Programs

9. How easy is it for you to follow the prayers, Kidase, readings, and responses? (Select one)

☐ Very easy

☐ Mostly easy

☐ Sometimes difficult

☐ Very difficult

10. How do you evaluate the overall Sunday schedule and service timing? (Mahlet/Kidan early; Kidase 6:00–9:00 AM; Sibket & Mezmur ending 10:30–11:00 AM) (Select one)

☐ Highly appropriate and spiritually fulfilling

☐ Acceptable, but needs small timing adjustments

☐ Too long or challenging start/end time for family

☐ Prefer adjusted schedule

11. How do you feel about the usual Sunday Sermons (Sibket) length of about 30–40 minutes? (Select one)

☐ Deeply enriching, practical, and ideal length

☐ Good, but sermon is a little too long

☐ Moderately helpful; needs more focus on daily life/youth

☐ Desires deeper teaching / longer sermon

12. What is your assessment of the spiritual chanting, choir (Zema/Mezmur), and congregational participation? *(Select one)*

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Exceptional, deeply moving, and uplifting | ☐ Fair; requires better organization & choir training |
| ☐ Good, but needs broader congregational participation | ☐ Needs structural improvement |

13. What primarily prevents members from attending weekly Sunday Kidase regularly outside of major Feasts? *(Select all that apply)*

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Work schedules & modern life obligations | ☐ Distance & transportation constraints |
| ☐ Language or comprehension barriers | ☐ Need for clearer schedule & reminders |
| ☐ Lack of youth/children engagement during service | ☐ Need for stronger pastoral outreach & personal connection |

14. Please share one recommendation to strengthen worship, participation, or service timing:

SECTION 3: LANGUAGE, TRANSLATION & UNDERSTANDING

Our church seeks to deliver its spiritual services to faithful in their mother tongue languages: Tigrinya, English, and Ge'ez (for Zema).

15. Which language do you understand best for spiritual teaching? *(Select main)*

- | | | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|---|
| ☐ Tigrinya | ☐ English | ☐ Ge'ez | ☐ Bilingual (Tigrinya/English) |
| ☐ Other: _____ | | | |

16. Where would translation or language support help most? *(Select all that apply)*

- | | | |
|--|--|--|
| ☐ Kidase / Liturgy text screens | ☐ Sibket / Sermon translation | ☐ Sunday School & Youth |
| ☐ Sacrament Preparation | ☐ Announcements & Bulletins | ☐ Scripture Readings |

17. How do you feel about the current practice of using more English on one Sunday each month for children, youth, and English-speaking members (3:1 language ratio)? *(Select one)*

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ Strongly support | ☐ Support | ☐ Neutral / no preference |
| ☐ Do not support | ☐ Need more information | |

18. What specific language support would help you or your children benefit more fully from church services, and why?

SECTION 4: HOLY SACRAMENTS & PASTORAL CARE

Please answer from your experience. Sacraments include Baptism, Chrismation, Eucharist, Confession, Matrimony, Holy Orders, & Anointing of the Sick.

19. Do you currently have an assigned Repentance Father (Confessor)? *(Select one)*

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Yes, dedicated Spiritual Father at this parish | ☐ No, but seeking guidance to find one |
| ☐ Yes, at another Orthodox Tewahedo parish | ☐ No, I do not currently have one |

20. How regularly do you meet with your Repentance Father or Clergy for spiritual counseling and confession? *(Select one)*

- | | | | |
|---|---|--|--|
| ☐ Monthly or as needed | ☐ Every 2–3 months | ☐ During major Fasts/Feasts | ☐ Rarely or Never |
|---|---|--|--|

21. When you request a sacramental or pastoral service, how supported do you feel by the clergy and church? *(Select one)*

- | | | | | |
|---|------------------------------------|---|---|---|
| ☐ Very supported | ☐ Supported | ☐ Somewhat supported | ☐ Not supported enough | ☐ Have not requested |
|---|------------------------------------|---|---|---|

22. How often do clergy or designated church servants check on your family's spiritual and personal well-being? *(Select one)*

- | | | | | |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Regularly | ☐ Sometimes | ☐ Rarely | ☐ Never | ☐ New to church |
|------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------|--|

23. Which forms of pastoral care should be strengthened most? *(Select all that apply)*

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Home/hospital visits for sick & elderly | ☐ Support during financial or personal hardship |
| ☐ Spiritual counseling & repentance guidance | ☐ Newcomer welcome and follow-up outreach |
| ☐ Support during bereavement & grief | ☐ Pre-marital & family counseling |

24. Please recommend one way our respected clergy/fathers and servants can strengthen pastoral care and relationships with the faithful:

SECTION 5: YOUTH, CHILDREN & YOUNG ADULT MINISTRY

Our children and youth are precious members of the Church and future servants of the Faith.

25. Do you have children, teenagers, or young adults in your household attending church? *(Select all that apply)*

- | | | | |
|---|---|---|--|
| ☐ Yes – ages 0–9 | ☐ Yes – ages 10–17 | ☐ Yes – ages 18–30 | ☐ No / Not applicable |
|---|---|---|--|

26. How effective are church programs in nurturing the spiritual growth of youth and children? *(Select one)*

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Highly effective; robust Orthodox education | ☐ Moderate; needs modern & bilingual approaches |
| ☐ Inadequate; urgently needs dedicated Youth Ministry | ☐ Unsure / Not applicable |

27. Which programs should be strengthened for children and youth? (Select all that apply)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Age-graded Sunday School curriculum | ☐ Clergy, deacon & adult mentorship programs |
| ☐ English Bible Study & Apologetics classes | ☐ Youth fellowship retreats, outings & service projects |
| ☐ Sacred Zema, Mezmur, & Liturgical response training | ☐ Parent support and family faith resources |

28. What is the single most important action our parish must take to keep our youth strong in faith?

SECTION 6: CHURCH ENVIRONMENT, FACILITIES & EQUIPMENT

Please consider cleanliness, comfort, safety, accessibility, parking, classrooms, restrooms, sound, screens, seating, AC, and the elevator.

29. How do you rate the overall cleanliness, atmosphere, and comfort of church facilities? (Upstairs, Dejeselam, Classrooms, Restrooms, etc.) (Select one)

- | | | | |
|--|--|---|--|
| ☐ Exceptional / Excellent | ☐ Satisfactory / Good | ☐ Fair (Minor care needed) | ☐ Needs major cleanup |
|--|--|---|--|

30. How do you rate the sound system and your ability to hear prayers, readings, mezmur, and sermons? (Select one)

- | | | | |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Excellent | ☐ Good | ☐ Fair | ☐ Needs improvement |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--|

31. How helpful are the display screens for prayers, readings, announcements, and translations? (Select one)

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Fully functional, clear audio and screen visibility | ☐ Sound system needs tuning/clarity improvement |
| ☐ Adequate, but display text/translations need enhancement | ☐ Needs immediate technical upgrade |

32. Which equipment or comfort item needs improvement first? (Select up to two)

- | | | | |
|---------------------------------------|---|--|--|
| ☐ Sound system | ☐ Display screens / visual | ☐ Chairs or seating | ☐ Air conditioning / temp |
| ☐ Elevator | ☐ Lighting | ☐ Other: _____ | |

33. Which facility area requires the most immediate attention? (Select primary)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Worship area | ☐ Dejeselam and common areas |
| ☐ Sanctuary surroundings | ☐ Sunday school and Children's classrooms |
| ☐ Parking and traffic flow | ☐ Accessibility for elders & people with disabilities |
| ☐ Building safety and signs | |

SECTION 7: COMMUNICATION, FELLOWSHIP & COMMUNITY SUPPORT

Strong communication and loving fellowship help the church serve members in both joyful and difficult times.

34. How do you rate church announcements and communication? (Select one)

- | | | | |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Excellent | ☐ Good | ☐ Fair | ☐ Needs improvement |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--|

35. How do you prefer to receive church announcements and spiritual resources? (Select all that apply)

- | | | | |
|---|---|--|--------------------------------|
| ☐ In-person announcement | ☐ Text / SMS | ☐ WhatsApp / Viber | ☐ Email |
| ☐ Church website | ☐ Printed notice | ☐ Facebook / social media | |

36. How well does the church support members during illness, bereavement, family crisis, or hardship? (Select one)

- | | | | | |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|--|--|
| ☐ Very well | ☐ Well | ☐ Sometimes | ☐ Needs improvement | ☐ I do not know |
|------------------------------------|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|--|--|

37. Which community ministries should be strengthened? (Select all that apply)

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Newcomer welcome and follow-up | ☐ Care for elders and homebound members |
| ☐ Family fellowship | ☐ Young-adult fellowship |
| ☐ Charity and outreach | ☐ Support for families in crisis |
| ☐ Community education and workshops | ☐ Evangelism and mission |

38. What is one practical way the church can strengthen Christian fellowship and care among members?

SECTION 8: SERVICE, VOLUNTEERING & STEWARDSHIP

Every member has God-given gifts that build up the Church. Stewardship includes prayer, time, talent, and faithful giving.

39. In which ways would you be willing to serve? (Select all that apply)

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Zema / choir / worship support | ☐ Cleaning, setup, maintenance, or gardening |
| ☐ Sunday School or youth teaching | ☐ Welcoming and newcomer support |
| ☐ Media, sound, screens, photo, or tech | ☐ Charity, visitation, or outreach |
| ☐ Fundraising or event organization | ☐ Professional skills (finance, legal, health, etc.) |
| ☐ I need more information before volunteering | |

40. How clear is the church's teaching and communication about Asrat, Bekurat, offerings, and other forms of stewardship? (Select one)

- | | | | |
|--|---------------------------------------|---|------------------------------------|
| ☐ Very clear | ☐ Mostly clear | ☐ Somewhat unclear | ☐ Not clear |
| ☐ I am new and have not received this information | | | |

41. What would make it easier for members to volunteer or serve? *(Select all that apply)*

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Clear ministry roles | ☐ A volunteer sign-up form |
| ☐ Training and guidance | ☐ Personal invitation and follow-up |
| ☐ A regular schedule | ☐ Childcare during service activities |
| ☐ Recognition and encouragement | ☐ Other: _____ |

42. Which type of support are you willing to offer for the church's mission? *(Select all that apply)*

- | | | |
|--|--|---|
| ☐ Prayer | ☐ Regular giving | ☐ Special project or building contribution |
| ☐ Volunteer time | ☐ Professional or technical expertise | |
| ☐ Inviting others | ☐ Outreach & charity | ☐ Need more information |

SECTION 9: CHURCH LEADERSHIP, ADMINISTRATION & FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY

This section concerns clergy leadership, Sebekia Gubae, communication, property care, and responsible stewardship.

43. How much confidence do you have in the church leadership's spiritual direction and service to the congregation? *(Select one)*

- | | | |
|---|---|--|
| ☐ Very high confidence | ☐ High confidence | ☐ Some confidence |
| ☐ Low confidence | ☐ Not enough information to answer | |

44. How clearly does the Sebekia Gubae communicate important decisions, plans, and responsibilities? *(Select one)*

- | | | | | |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Very clearly | ☐ Clearly | ☐ Sometimes clearly | ☐ Not clearly | ☐ I do not know |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------------|--|--------------------------------------|--|

45. How confident are you that church money, Asrat, Bekurat, offerings, and property are managed responsibly and transparently? *(Select one)*

- | | | | | |
|---|------------------------------------|---|--|--|
| ☐ Very confident | ☐ Confident | ☐ Somewhat confident | ☐ Not confident | ☐ Not enough info |
|---|------------------------------------|---|--|--|

46. Which administrative practices would most improve trust and participation? *(Select up to three)*

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Regular financial summaries | ☐ Clear annual plans and goals |
| ☐ Better explanation of major decisions | ☐ More opportunities for member questions |
| ☐ Clear volunteer and ministry responsibilities | ☐ Faster response to concerns |
| ☐ Consistent policies and procedures | |

47. What is one constructive recommendation for the clergy, Sebekia Gubae, or church administration?

SECTION 10: NEW CHURCH BUILDING, GROWTH & EVANGELICAL MISSION

Please consider the parish's future, the new building, outreach, and service to present and future generations.

48. Have you visited or seen the new church building project? *(Select one)*

- | | | | |
|--|---|---|---|
| ☐ Yes – visited in person | ☐ Seen photos or updates | ☐ Aware, but not visited | ☐ Not yet / not informed |
|--|---|---|---|

49. How informed do you feel about the new building's progress, needs, and next steps? *(Select one)*

- | | | | |
|--|-----------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ Very informed | ☐ Informed | ☐ Somewhat informed | ☐ Not informed |
|--|-----------------------------------|--|---------------------------------------|

50. How do you rate the progress of the building modification and preparation work? *(Select one)*

- | | | | | |
|---|--|---------------------------------------|--|--|
| ☐ Excellent progress | ☐ Good progress | ☐ Satisfactory | ☐ Moving too slowly | ☐ Not enough info |
|---|--|---------------------------------------|--|--|

51. Which priorities are most important as the church grows? *(Select up to three)*

- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Complete the new building responsibly | ☐ Expand children and youth ministry |
| ☐ Strengthen clergy and pastoral-care capacity | ☐ Develop charity and community outreach |
| ☐ Improve worship, teaching, and language access | ☐ Build stronger financial sustainability |
| ☐ Train future servants, deacons, teachers, & leaders | ☐ Strengthen evangelism and welcome new families |

52. What major recommendation do you have for expanding the church's evangelical mission and spiritual service?

SECTION 11: OVERALL SPIRITUAL REFLECTION & PRAYERFUL RECOMMENDATIONS

Your final reflections will guide the spiritual growth, unity, and sacred mission of our holy parish.

53. Overall, how satisfied are you with the church's worship, spiritual care, teaching, fellowship, facilities, and administration? *(Select one)*

- | | | | | |
|---|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|
| ☐ Very satisfied | ☐ Satisfied | ☐ Neutral | ☐ Dissatisfied | ☐ Very dissatisfied |
|---|------------------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------|--|

54. What is one sacred practice or service that our church does especially well and should preserve?

55. What is the single most important recommendation or vision you wish to share with our Clergy and Sebekia Gubae?

56. Please share any other prayerful recommendation, concern, or idea that could strengthen the spiritual life, unity, and service of our church:

"May the God of peace, through the intercession of the Holy Mother Saint Mary and Saint Abune Aregawi, bless you and your family with abundant spiritual grace and peace. Amen."

Thank you for your pious contribution to the spiritual growth and mission of Debre Tsehay Abune Aregawi Church!